



TSUKIMI



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TSUKIMI

AMUSE BOUCHE

Pomme Soufflé with Black Truffle and Truffle Mousse
Sandwich of Avocado, Shiso, Olive, and Fried Nori Chip
Wagyu and Pear Tart with Oboro Kombu

UNI

Hokkaido Uni with Golden Osetra Caviar
Potato Cream and Koshihikari Rice

OWAN

Lotus Root Soup with Yuzu
Lightly Fried and Oven-Baked Shima Aji from Ehime

SASHIMI

Madai from Ehime
Finger Lime, Yuzu Pepper, and Mustard Frills

TUNA

Fried Rice Quinoa Ball with Raw Tuna from Mie with Kombu, Sesame, and Nori

CASHEW-TOFU

Cashew-nut Tofu with Perigord Truffle and Fig

MAINE LOBSTER

Charcoal Grilled, Serve with Maitake and Shoyu-Mirin Sauce

HATA

Key Lime, Shiso, and Pea Tendrils

WAGYU AND RICE

Yukitsubaki Rice from Uonuma, A5 Wagyu from Hyōgo, Horseradish and Egg Yolk

ROSÉ JELLY

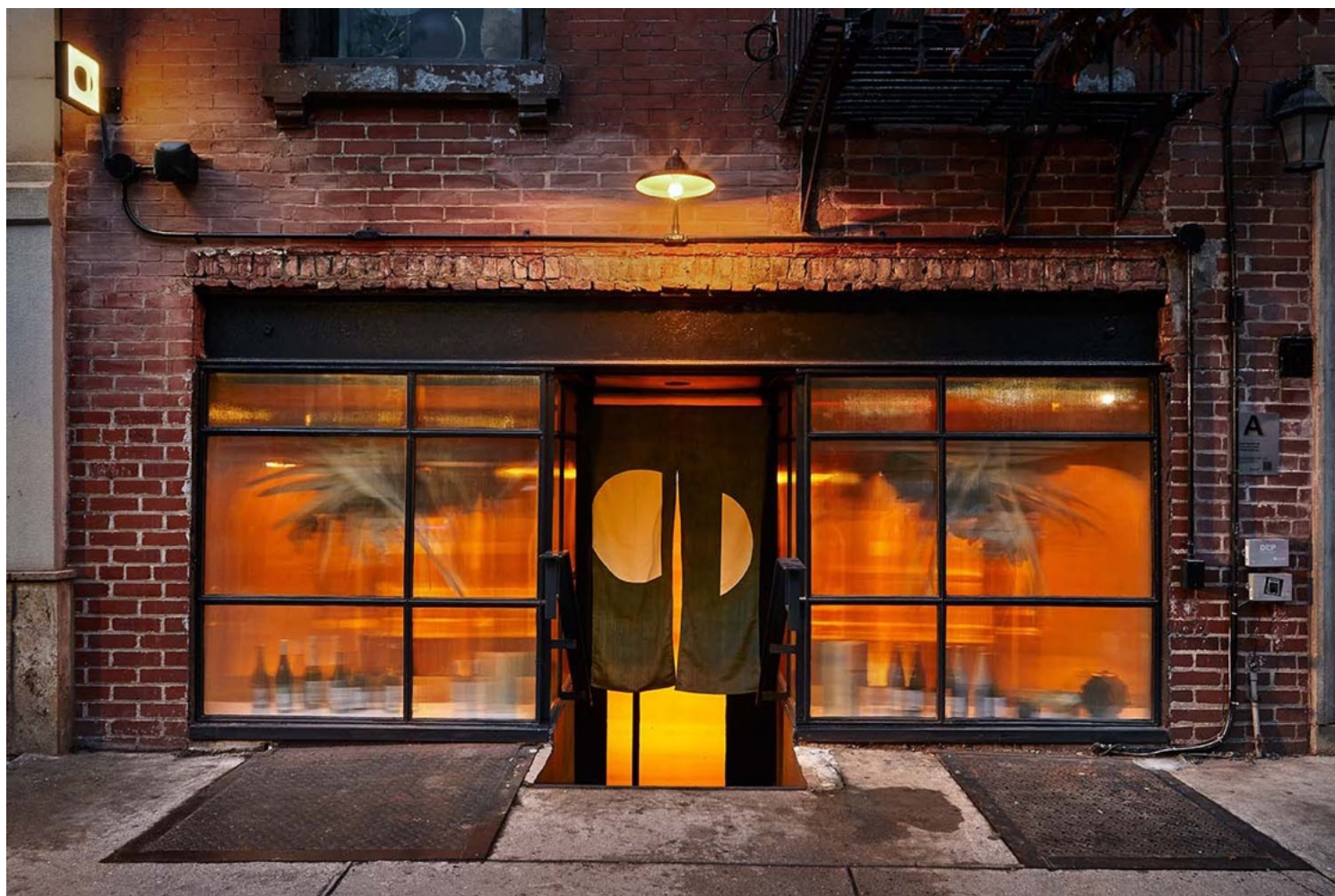
With Strawberry and Crème Anglaise

FUJI APPLE SOUFFLÉ

With Potato Chip Ice Cream

MANJŪ AND MATCHA

Earl Grey and Azuki Bean Manjū with Matcha



CONTEMPLATION | GRATITUDE | TOGETHERNESS

These are themes surrounding the long-held tradition of “Tsukimi,” which refers to a mid-autumn harvest festival honoring the moon at its fullest and brightest. Here at the heart of the East Village, Tsukimi strives to bring a new interpretation to Japanese cuisine. While Tsukimi team embrace tradition, they continue to reimagine and change. The Japanese saying “温故知新” rings true to their approach: attain wisdom from tradition and history to create something new and better.



My dinner journey at Tsukimi unfolds on a trio of amuse bouche, starting with a pomme soufflé filled with truffle mousse, then a sandwich of avocado, shiso, olive, and fried nori chip, ending with a wagyu-pear tart with oboro kombu. While the pomme soufflé satisfies my palate with its classical flavor with a crowning touch of the richness from truffle, the next two bites are somehow strange. The olive tastes piquant and pungent in the next bite, completely shadowing the smoothness of avocado and the aromas of nori and shiso. As for the tart, the unctuousness of wagyu meets the umami unique fragrance of oboro kombu but yields a somehow strange flavor. The unctuousness is also too rich to be balanced by the pear.





The first appetizer is the absolute classic of all time on Tsukimi's menu: the uni and caviar dish with potato cream and Koshihikari rice. The silky and velvety texture of potato cream resembles the traditional egg chawanmushi, while its richness and creaminess surpass the quivering custardy texture. The Koshihikari rice brings an additional layer of texture, it is creamy yet al dente that, together with the potato, creates a risotto-like mouth-feel. The uni adds another dimension of nuance in terms of the smooth texture. In addition, it adds on rich umami and tropical fruity freshness. On top of the nuances of creaminess and silkiness comes the caviar that counters the melange with its oceanic freshness and brininess and popping texture.

Next up is a lotus root soup Owan dish with yuzu and shima aji. Sourcing from Ehime prefecture, the shima aji is first lightly-fried then oven-baked. While it exhibits rich umami and essential brininess, the texture is on the dry side. The texture of the soup is what the chef innovated. Unlike traditional clear soup, this lotus root soup is translucent and velvety due to the intervention of starch. The use of fragrant marigold and parsley introduces a pleasant herbal-floral aroma profile to the medley, resulting in its lightly sweet taste and refreshing palate. The only minus could be the abrupt transition between soup and fish, possibly due to the sophisticated nature of shima aji.





Tsukimi's interpretation of sashimi is a far cry from the tradition. Today's sashimi dish features madai from Ehime prefecture. The madai is served with finger lime, yuzu pepper, mustard frills, nasturtium leaves, and marigold. Such a version resembles more of a contemporary cuisine dish as the sweet aroma and herbal floral notes are overshadowing the pristine umami of fish per se. Next up is a fried rice quinoa ball with raw tuna from Mie prefecture, further seasoned with kombu, sesame, and nori. The subtle contrasts between rice and quinoa as well as kombu and nori make the small bite full of surprise. The final appetizer features a cashew tofu with perigord truffle and fig. The rich nuttiness is sublimated by the earthy aroma of truffle, while fig is introduced to counter the heaviness of the whole with its freshness and unique flavor.





The first main course presented is a charcoal-grilled Maine lobster served with maitake and shoyu-mirin sauce. The charcoal aroma of the lobster is sublimated by the earthiness of maitake as well as the rich umami from the sauce. In contrast to the heaviness, an extremely light dish featuring Hata fish from Mie prefecture is presented. The hata fish comes with key lime, shiso, and pea tendrils, resulting in a weird imbalance in which the rich unctuousness of Hata completely overshadows the light, citrusy, and herbal supplements. Next up is the Gohan dish showcasing the extremely rare yukitsubaki rice. Served with Hyogo wagyu beef, horseradish, and egg yolk, the overall dryness leads to the consequence that such precious rice fails to fully express its finesse.





The last three-quarters of the menu contributes to desserts. A rosé jelly with strawberry and anglaise sauce is presented as a palate cleanser that escorts our palate to cross the boundary from savories to sweets. The jelly made by gelatin is on the crispy side that resembles Kanten jelly, corresponding to the freshness of strawberry and the lightness of the anglaise. The main dessert features the notorious fuji apple soufflé. The soufflé per se enunciates subtle sweetness that is unexpectedly counterpointed by the sweet-savory potato chip ice cream, leading the melange to reach this very characteristic equilibrium. The coda of the dinner is marked by matcha tea and a small bite of earl grey and Azuki Manju. Unfortunately, the aroma of the earl grey fails to fit the atmosphere and when colliding with matcha, the two worlds of tea cannot merge to create harmony.

